



17–19 cm
6½–7½ in

FOX SPARROW
Passerella iliaca

Widespread throughout N. America, this large sparrow has a red-streaked back and chest. It usually forages in low vegetation.

long, rounded,
plain tail



17–19 cm
6½–7½ in

WHITE-CROWNED SPARROW
Zonotrichia leucophrys

This N. American bird is usually found in low vegetation or on the ground. It has distinctive black and white head markings.



14–16 cm
5½–6½ in

SONG SPARROW
Melospiza melodia

A common N. American bird from Alaska to Mexico, this species has a large number of races. It is named for its melodious song.

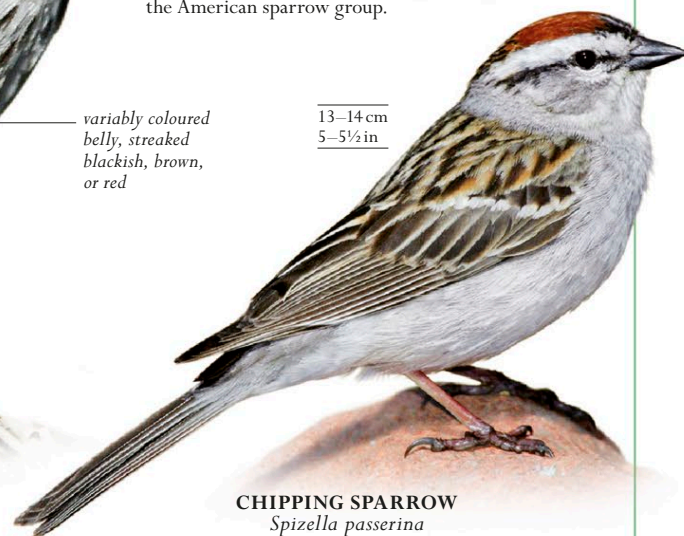
variably coloured
belly, streaked
blackish, brown,
or red



18 cm
7 in

LARK-BUNTING
Calamospiza melanocorys

A bird of the N. American prairies, the lark-bunting is a ground-nesting member of the American sparrow group.



13–14 cm
5–5½ in

CHIPPING SPARROW
Spizella passerina

A rufous (reddish brown)-capped bird common in open woodland across N. America, the chipping sparrow has a distinctive “chipping” trill.



RED-CRESTED CARDINAL
Paroaria coronata

Birds of the *Paroaria* genus are found in S. America. This is a common species in open woodland.

19 cm
7½ in



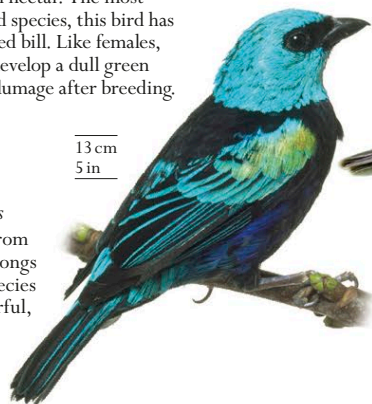
RED-LEGGED HONEYCREEPER
Cyanerpes cyaneus

Tropical American honeycreepers feed on nectar. The most widespread species, this bird has a decurved bill. Like females, males develop a dull green “eclipse” plumage after breeding.

13 cm
5 in

BLUE-NECKED TANAGER
Tangara cyanicollis

This open forest bird from northern S. America belongs to a group of tanager species with particularly colourful, iridescent plumage.



CARDINALS AND RELATIVES

These mostly chunky-billed birds are seed-eaters like buntings, and many have bright colours like tanagers. Related to both, the Cardinalidae belong to a large group of American passerines that are derived from finches.

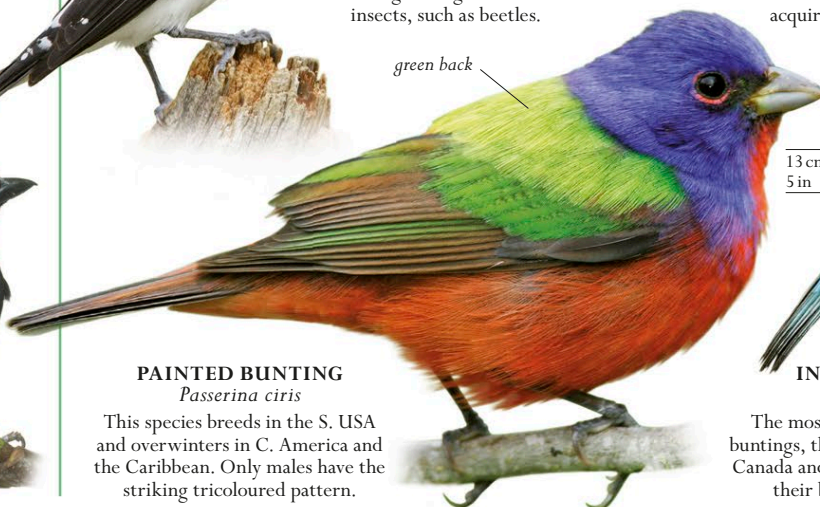


18–21 cm
7–8½ in

ROSE-BREASTED GROSBEAK
Pheucticus ludovicianus

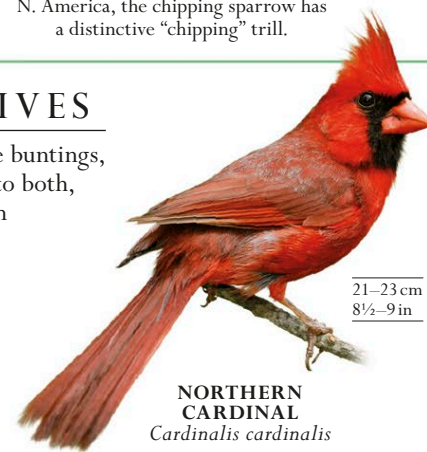
This migratory American cardinal grosbeak has a typically heavy bill for feeding on large seeds and on insects, such as beetles.

green back



PAINTED BUNTING
Passerina ciris

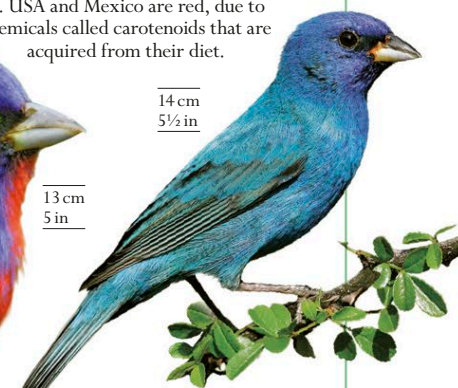
This species breeds in the S. USA and overwinters in C. America and the Caribbean. Only males have the striking tricoloured pattern.



21–23 cm
8½–9 in

NORTHERN CARDINAL
Cardinalis cardinalis

The males of this resident of the E. USA and Mexico are red, due to chemicals called carotenoids that are acquired from their diet.



14 cm
5½ in

INDIGO BUNTING
Passerina cyanea

The most wide ranging of the blue buntings, this species migrates between Canada and S. America. The males lose their blue plumage in winter.